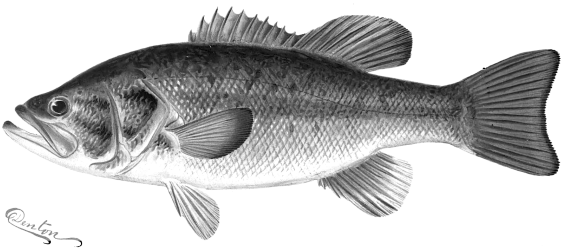


Largemouth Bass

Micropterus salmoides

The weed-edge ambusher — Pine Lake & North Lake



The Large-Mouthed Black Bass — chromolithograph by S. F. Denton, New York Commissioners of Fisheries, Game and Forests, 1896–1902. Public domain; converted to grayscale for printing.

Tell it apart

The jaw. On a largemouth the upper jaw reaches *past* the back of the eye; on a smallmouth it stops under the eye. Largemouth are green with one ragged dark stripe down the side, and the dorsal fin is pinched almost in two.

Size here

12–16 in is a normal fish, 18 in is a good one, 20 in is a trophy for these lakes. State record 11 lb 3 oz.

Spawn

Beds in 1–4 ft of sand or gravel in protected bays when the water holds 60–65 °F — late May into June. The male fans the bed and guards the fry for weeks afterward.

Eats

Anything it can fit: bluegill, perch, crayfish, frogs, young of its own kind.

Season

J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■

Time of day

Dawn	Mid	Dusk	Night
■	■	■	■

Where

- Pine

Spots **5** (west shelf), **6** (west bay), **7** (south-east bay). The water is so clear that the weed line runs to 15–20 ft, and so does the bass. Do not stop fishing at 8 ft because that is where you would stop on a normal lake.
- North

Spots **1**, **4**, **5**, **7**. Stained water pulls them shallow — 4–10 ft is the band.
- Structure

Weed edges, isolated weed clumps, fallen wood, docks, and any hard-to-soft bottom transition. A largemouth wants something to hide behind and open water to charge into.

How

- Search

Spinnerbait or a squarebill crankbait along the weed edge to find active fish fast, then slow down and pick the area apart.
- In the weeds

Texas-rigged plastic worm or creature bait, *see the **Texas rig** sheet*. Weedless, sinks slowly, comes through everything.
- Pressured or clear

Weightless wacky-rigged worm, *see the **wacky rig** sheet*. On Pine Lake in bright sun this out-fishes everything else.
- Deep

A jig-and-craw or a Carolina rig on the outside weed edge, *see the **Carolina rig** sheet*.
- First and last light

A walking topwater or a popper over the weed tops. The best half hour of the day.
- For a beginner

A nightcrawler under a slip bobber set to hang just above the weeds. It is not fancy and it works.

The one thing to remember

Largemouth relate to *cover*, not depth. Find the edge — of the weeds, of the shade, of the drop — and fish it. In the middle of a featureless flat there is no bass.

Regulations on these waters, 2026–27. 14 in minimum, 5 per day, open 2 May–7 March. Catch-and-release open all year. *These change; only the Wisconsin DNR’s current publication for this exact water body is authoritative.*